HAIR LOSS
12

# Dutasteride

Synthetic 4-azasteroid that blocks type 1 and type 2 5α-reductase, taken by mouth



**CLASS**
5α-reductase inhibitor

**STUDIED FOR**
Enlarged prostate, hair loss

**HUMAN EVIDENCE**
Large trials; FDA approved (BPH)

**US STATUS**
FDA approved (Avodart); hair off-label

## STUDIED FOR

**Enlarged prostate**
HUMAN

**Male pattern loss**
HUMAN

**Hair loss is off-label in the US.** Japan approved it for male pattern hair loss in 2015. US hair-loss use is off-label.

## HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Dutasteride ▶ 5α-reductase 1+2 ▶ Less DHT ▶ Prostate, scalp

- **Inhibits conversion** of testosterone to DHT, per the label
- **Blocks both isoforms;** type 1 is also active in skin and liver
- **Blood DHT** fell by a median 90% after 2 weeks at 0.5 mg a day
- **Testosterone** rose by about 19%, staying in the normal range

## EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

### EVIDENCE

**FDA APPROVED**
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Approved for BPH in 2001
- Hair: 3 Phase 3 trials, 24 weeks to 6 months
- Largest hair trial: 917 men vs finasteride

### NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use for hair loss
- Persistent sexual effects' cause
- Sperm effects on fertility

## QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

**HALF-LIFE**
About 5 weeks; detectable 4 to 6 months after stopping

**ROUTES STUDIED**
By mouth (capsules)

**PHARMACOKINETICS**
Peak in 2 to 3 hours; liver metabolism (CYP3A4, CYP3A5)

**SOLD AS**
Prescription capsules (Avodart, Jalyn, generics)

**MONITORED IN TRIALS**
PSA (lowered about 50%), sexual effects, mood

**SPORT (WADA)**
Not on the 2026 list

**REGULATORY**

| | |
|---|---|
| FDA | Approved for BPH (2001); hair loss is off-label |
| PMDA | Approved for male pattern hair loss (2015) |
| EMA | 2025 review added mood information |
| WADA | Not on the 2026 list |


**REFERENCES**

1. FDA, Avodart prescribing information (DailyMed), Mar 2025
2. Gubelin Harcha et al., J Am Acad Dermatol, dutasteride vs finasteride, Mar 2014
3. EMA, finasteride and dutasteride referral, accessed Nov 2026



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